

ALDER CREEK TRANSIT DISTRICT

Risk & Claims Division

1200 Alder Creek Way · Rivergate, California 91766 · (626) 555-0100

CERTIFIED TRANSCRIPT OF RECORDED STATEMENT

Claim reference: ACTD Reyes / 10-18-2025 collision file
Claimant: Yolanda Reyes
Interviewer: Gordon Espinoza, Risk & Claims Manager, Alder Creek Transit District
Date of statement: 02/18/2026
Time commenced: 10:07 a.m. Pacific
Time concluded: 10:49 a.m. Pacific
Duration: Approximately 42 minutes
Mode: Telephonic
Recording medium: Digital audio, ACTD Claims call-recording platform, file ID GE-2026-0218-01
Consent basis: Two-party consent obtained on the record pursuant to California Penal Code § 632
Claimant representation at time of statement: Pro se — no counsel of record

Certification. I, Gordon Espinoza, certify that the following pages are a true and correct transcript of the recorded statement of Yolanda Reyes taken by me on 02/18/2026. The audio file has been retained in the claims file and is available for verification.

/s/ G. Espinoza
Gordon Espinoza
ACTD Risk & Claims Manager
Date-stamped: 02/18/2026

(Copy furnished to claimant Yolanda Reyes at 612 Poplar Street, Rivergate, CA 91766, by first-class mail on 02/23/2026.)

TRANSCRIPT

ESPINOZA: Good morning. This is Gordon Espinoza with the Alder Creek Transit District, Risk and Claims. Today's date is February 18th, 2026, and the time is a little after 10:00 a.m. I'm on the line with Ms. Yolanda Reyes. Ms. Reyes, can you hear me clearly?

REYES: Yes, I can hear you fine.

ESPINOZA: Thank you. Before we go any further, I want to let you know this call is being recorded. Under California law, Penal Code section 632, I need your consent on the record to record. Do I have your permission to record this conversation?

REYES: Yes. You have my permission to record it.

ESPINOZA: Thank you. And do you understand that this is a recorded statement being taken in connection with the collision that occurred on October 18th of last year?

REYES: Yes, I understand.

ESPINOZA: Are you speaking to me on your own behalf today, without an attorney?

REYES: Yes. I have not hired a lawyer. I am speaking for myself.

ESPINOZA: Is anyone else in the room with you or on the line?

REYES: No. It's just me. I'm sitting at the kitchen table in my apartment.

ESPINOZA: Are you comfortable proceeding? If you need a break at any point, or if you want to stop, please just say so.

REYES: I'm okay. I'd rather just get through it.

ESPINOZA: Understood. Let me start with some basic identifying information. Can you please state your full legal name for the record?

REYES: Yolanda Reyes.

ESPINOZA: Any middle name?

REYES: Marisol. Yolanda Marisol Reyes.

ESPINOZA: And your date of birth?

REYES: June 22, 1991.

ESPINOZA: What is your current residential address?

REYES: 612 Poplar Street, Rivergate, California, 91766.

ESPINOZA: How long have you lived at 612 Poplar Street?

REYES: About four and a half years now. Since the spring of 2021.

ESPINOZA: Is that the address where I should send you a copy of this transcript when it's prepared?

REYES: Yes. That's my mailing address. I'm back home now, so mail there reaches me.

ESPINOZA: And your telephone number?

REYES: (626) 555-0187. That's my cell. It's the best number for me.

ESPINOZA: Any other number I should have on file?

REYES: No, just that one. I don't have a landline.

ESPINOZA: Thank you. Ms. Reyes, before we discuss the incident itself, I want to ask a few questions about how you're feeling today and generally over the last couple of weeks. Are you able to answer questions today on your own behalf, without assistance?

REYES: Yes. My doctors cleared me. The temporary conservatorship my sister had was ended by the court at the beginning of this month. I've been handling my own affairs since then.

ESPINOZA: When was that ended, if you remember?

REYES: February 5th. I remember because I signed the paperwork at the rehab facility that afternoon and my sister took me out to dinner after.

ESPINOZA: All right. And you feel able to give me a coherent account today?

REYES: Yes. My memory of the day of the accident itself has a hole in it, and I'll tell you about that. But I can talk with you and answer what you ask me. My speech therapist says my word-finding is basically back to normal. I still get tired if I concentrate for a long time. That's why I asked to do this in the morning.

ESPINOZA: Understood. If you get tired, tell me. Let's talk a little about your background first. Where were you employed at the time of the collision?

REYES: Coastline Home Goods. The store at the Rivergate shopping plaza. I was a sales associate there.

ESPINOZA: How long had you worked at Coastline?

REYES: A little over seven years. I started in the summer of 2018.

ESPINOZA: What were your hours and pay?

REYES: I was scheduled thirty-four hours a week, most weeks. Sometimes a little more if we were short-staffed. My hourly rate was twenty-three fifty. Twenty-three dollars and fifty cents.

ESPINOZA: Were you working overnight? I ask because the collision was around two in the morning.

REYES: No, I don't work overnights. That night I had closed out the register. We closed at ten on Fridays. Then a few of us went out after — just to get something to eat. I was on my way home from that. Not from work directly.

ESPINOZA: Where had you been that evening, between leaving the store and heading home?

REYES: We went to a diner. It's on Broadway, a few blocks over from Main. I was with two coworkers. We were there until sometime after one, maybe one-thirty. Then they went one way and I walked toward Main to catch the Owl bus home.

ESPINOZA: Do you remember which stop you walked to?

REYES: The stop on Main just north of Third. That's the one I always take when I've been downtown late. The 512 comes through there.

ESPINOZA: All right. Take me through what you remember from the time you got to that stop.

REYES: I remember arriving at the stop. I remember it being cold. I had my jacket zipped up. I remember checking the schedule sign, and then I took out my phone to look at the arrival time on the transit app. I was standing under the sign, on the sidewalk. I remember pulling up the app and looking at the screen.

ESPINOZA: Do you remember what the app told you?

REYES: I remember it said the bus was a few minutes out. I don't remember the exact number. Maybe four minutes, maybe six. I remember thinking it wouldn't be long.

ESPINOZA: Do you remember anything after that?

REYES: No. That's where it ends. The next thing I remember is waking up in the hospital. I don't remember the bus. I don't remember being hit. I don't remember any of that. It's just gone.

ESPINOZA: Do you remember hearing anything — a horn, tires, brakes, anything like that — before the gap in your memory?

REYES: No. Nothing. I've tried. I've talked to the neuropsychologist about it. He said that kind of gap is common with the injury I had. But I want to be honest with you — I don't remember it. I'm not going to make something up.

ESPINOZA: I appreciate that. Do you remember seeing the bus approach at all?

REYES: No.

ESPINOZA: Do you remember seeing any other pedestrians or vehicles in the area while you were waiting?

REYES: I don't have a clear picture. It was quiet, that's my general sense. It was late and there wasn't a lot of traffic. But I couldn't tell you if a specific car went by or anything like that. I was looking at my phone.

ESPINOZA: Do you remember what the lighting was like at the stop?

REYES: There was a streetlight there. The one on the corner. It was on when I got to the stop. I remember because when I looked up from my phone toward the direction the bus would come from, the light was on. Whether it stayed on the whole time, I couldn't tell you. I don't remember.

ESPINOZA: Had you been drinking that evening?

REYES: I had one beer at the diner, with my food. That was around midnight, twelve-thirty. Just the one. I wasn't impaired. I walked to the bus stop without any trouble. My coworkers can confirm that if you need.

ESPINOZA: Any other substances — medications, anything like that?

REYES: No. I was not on any medication at that time. Nothing.

ESPINOZA: Were you wearing headphones or earbuds while you were waiting?

REYES: No. I don't wear headphones when I'm walking or waiting alone at night. My mother drilled that into me a long time ago. Both ears open.

ESPINOZA: Where were you standing exactly, at the stop — right at the curb, back from the curb?

REYES: Back from the curb. Under the sign. There's a little concrete area there and I was on it, closer to the building side than the street side. I wasn't standing in the street.

ESPINOZA: All right. Let's talk about waking up in the hospital. Do you remember that?

REYES: Bits of it. The first real memory I have is a nurse. She was leaning over me and asking my name. I couldn't answer her. My mouth wasn't working right and there was a tube. I remember panicking. Then I don't remember much for a while after that. My sister told me later that was several days into it. I was in the ICU for weeks. I don't have clear memories of most of that time.

ESPINOZA: When did your continuous memory start to come back — where you remember days in order?

REYES: Sometime in December. Maybe the middle of December. I remember Christmas at the rehab facility. That's a clear memory. Everything before that is patchy.

ESPINOZA: You mentioned rehab. Can you tell me where you've been treated?

REYES: After the trauma center — Rivergate Regional — I was transferred to the Alder Creek Neuro-Rehabilitation Institute. That's the inpatient facility over on Recovery Parkway. I was there as an inpatient until the end of January. Since then I've been going back three days a week for outpatient therapy. Physical therapy, occupational therapy, speech, and I have appointments with the neuropsychologist.

ESPINOZA: Who are the doctors you're seeing regularly?

REYES: My physiatrist is Dr. Vasquez-Ortiz. She's the one who oversees the whole plan. The neuropsychologist is Dr. Vandenberg. There's a physical therapist I see, her name is Kim — I don't remember her last name off the top of my head, I'm sorry. And an occupational therapist named Rafael.

ESPINOZA: How would you describe your current condition, in your own words?

REYES: Better than it was. A lot better. I couldn't walk on my own until December. I use a cane now, mostly on my left side, and I can walk without it around the apartment but I use it outside. My right leg is still weaker. I have headaches, not every day but more than before. My short-term memory is not as sharp as it was. I keep a notebook. My therapist has me writing things down. I get tired quickly. If I have a long appointment day I sleep the whole next day.

ESPINOZA: Are you back to work?

REYES: No. Not yet. Coastline has held my position — the HR manager, Melinda Torres, has been kind about that. But I'm not medically cleared to go back. The plan right now is to start with a few hours a week when my physiatrist signs off. I don't know when that will be.

ESPINOZA: Are you managing your own household — bills, groceries, that sort of thing?

REYES: Yes, since the conservatorship ended. My sister still helps a lot. She comes over most days. But I pay my own bills. I do it on my laptop. I write down what I've done in the notebook so I don't do it twice. I went to the grocery store last week by myself. It took me longer than it used to and I was tired after, but I did it.

ESPINOZA: Any driving?

REYES: No. I'm not driving. The doctor hasn't cleared me for that. I take Access rides or my sister drives me.

ESPINOZA: Let me ask you about your feelings about the driver of the bus. Have you been told who was driving?

REYES: Yes. I've been told his name. Raymond Keeler. I saw it in a news article my sister showed me.

ESPINOZA: What are your feelings about him, if I can ask?

REYES: I don't know him. I've never met him. What I know is what I've read, which is that he was drunk. That's what the report said. That is very hard for me. I was standing at a bus stop. I was doing what you're supposed to do — waiting for the bus, minding my own business. I trusted that a bus driver on a public bus would be sober. I don't have a personal hatred toward him as a person. I don't know him as a person. But I am angry about what happened. I lost half a year of my life. I might not get all of me back. That's hard.

ESPINOZA: I understand. And I appreciate you being direct.

REYES: I'd rather just tell you than dance around it.

ESPINOZA: Have you had any contact with Mr. Keeler, or anyone on his behalf, since the collision?

REYES: No. None. I would not know what to say.

ESPINOZA: Have you spoken to anyone else about the collision — reporters, other lawyers, insurance adjusters?

REYES: No reporters. I haven't spoken to any other adjusters. There was a lawyer who left a card at the hospital, my sister said, but I never called them. I haven't hired anyone. You're the first person from the District I've spoken with directly. My sister took some calls when I was in the ICU but I don't know the details of those.

ESPINOZA: Are you considering retaining counsel?

REYES: I've been thinking about it. I haven't made up my mind. I want to understand what my options are first. That's part of why I said yes to this call — I wanted to hear what the District had to say and answer questions honestly.

ESPINOZA: That's your right, either way. Just so you know, if you do retain counsel, any future communications about the claim should ordinarily be routed through them.

REYES: I understand.

ESPINOZA: Let me go back to a few specifics to make sure I have them right. The collision was October 18th of last year, around two in the morning. Is that consistent with what you've been told?

REYES: Yes. That's what the doctors and the police report have said. October 18th, early morning hours.

ESPINOZA: And the location — a bus stop on South Main Street, near the intersection with Third Avenue?

REYES: Yes. The stop just north of Third, on the east side of Main. That's the one.

ESPINOZA: You had come from a diner on Broadway earlier that night?

REYES: Yes.

ESPINOZA: Do you recall the name of the diner?

REYES: The Blue Sparrow. It's open late on weekends.

ESPINOZA: Are you willing to identify the coworkers who were with you, so we can follow up if needed?

REYES: Yes. Elena Bautista and Marcus Yeoh. Both of them work at the same Coastline. I can get you their phone numbers, or you can go through Melinda in HR.

ESPINOZA: Thank you. That's helpful.

REYES: Sure.

ESPINOZA: A few more questions and then I'll wrap up. Have you kept a journal or any written record of your recovery or your symptoms?

REYES: The notebook I mentioned. It's mostly to-do lists and reminders. But I also write down when I have a bad headache, or when I'm having a hard word day. My occupational therapist asked me to.

ESPINOZA: Would you be willing to make that available if it becomes relevant?

REYES: I'd want to think about that. Some of what's in it is personal. I'd probably want to ask a lawyer before I hand over a whole notebook.

ESPINOZA: That's a fair answer. Are you presently claiming any specific out-of-pocket expenses that you've paid personally, as opposed to what insurance has paid?

REYES: I've been paying co-pays and some medications. My sister paid some things while I was in the ICU because I couldn't. I don't have the exact numbers memorized. There's a folder of receipts at the apartment. If you send me a written request I can put those together for you.

ESPINOZA: All right. Do you have BlueShield still, as your health plan?

REYES: Yes. And Medi-Cal kicked in at some point during the hospitalization. I don't fully understand how the two of them worked together but that's what the discharge people told me.

ESPINOZA: Understood. Is there anything about the incident or your condition that you feel we haven't covered that you want to say for the record?

REYES: Just — I want you to know that I'm not exaggerating anything. I've tried to tell you what I remember and be honest about what I don't remember. I'm not trying to make this bigger than it is. I also don't want to make it smaller than it is. What happened happened. I want to be treated fairly by your agency. That's it.

ESPINOZA: Understood, and noted. Ms. Reyes, before we conclude — is everything you've told me today true and accurate to the best of your knowledge?

REYES: Yes. To the best of my knowledge.

ESPINOZA: Has anyone from the District, or from anywhere else, pressured you to say anything specific today, or to leave anything out?

REYES: No. No one has pressured me. I said what I wanted to say.

ESPINOZA: Have you understood my questions?

REYES: Yes.

ESPINOZA: Have you had adequate opportunity to answer them?

REYES: Yes.

ESPINOZA: Then I'm going to conclude the statement. The time is 10:49 a.m. Pacific, and today's date is 02/18/2026. This concludes the recorded statement of Yolanda Reyes. Ms. Reyes, thank you for your time. A copy of the transcript, once prepared, will be mailed to you at 612 Poplar Street.

REYES: Thank you. Goodbye.

ESPINOZA: Goodbye.

(End of recorded statement — 10:49 a.m. Pacific, 02/18/2026.)

Transcriptionist's note. Transcribed from digital audio file GE-2026-0218-01 by C. Ibarra, ACTD Claims Support, 02/20/2026. Reviewed against audio by G. Espinoza on 02/20/2026. No material corrections. Non-substantive filler words ("um," "uh," short repetitions) omitted for readability; no substantive edits made.

Distribution.

- Original: ACTD Claims file, Reyes 10-18-2025 collision matter (retained under senior claims manager, G. Espinoza).
 - Copy 1: Claimant Yolanda Reyes, 612 Poplar Street, Rivergate, CA 91766 (mailed 02/23/2026, first-class).
 - Copy 2: ACTD General Counsel, D. Farkas.
 - Copy 3: Outside counsel, Delfino Marek LLP (M. Vega), by secure transmission.
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